Sergi Barcons

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Research Fields

Primary: Macroeconomics, Heterogeneous Agents, Monetary Policy

Secondary: Welfare Assessments, Housing, Fiscal Policy

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Toulouse School of Economics — 2021 – 2027 (expected)

M.Res. in Economics, Toulouse School of Economics — 2022 – 2023

M.Sc. in Economic Theory and Econometrics, Toulouse School of Economics — 2020 – 2022

B.Sc. in Mathematics and Economics, Toulouse School of Economics — 2017 – 2020

Research Positions

PhD Traineeship, European Central Bank — Oct 2025 – Sep 2026
Monetary Policy Research, Directorate General Research

Summer Graduate Research Program, Banco de México — Jun 2025 – Aug 2025
Directorate General of Economic Research

Job Market Paper

Rent Inflation and Monetary Policy

with Gonzalo Paz-Pardo (2026)

Rental prices enter the inflation indices that central banks target, yet rents behave unlike other consumer prices after a monetary policy shock. We build a Heterogeneous-Agent New Keynesian model where households rent, own, or become landlords, with endogenous house prices and rents, and sticky leases. A monetary tightening keeps would-be buyers renting, and rents rise until enough owners supply the extra rental housing. About three-quarters of the effect of higher interest rates on the rental market is supply-driven: higher financial returns and mortgage costs make supplying rental housing less attractive. We study how policy should treat rent inflation. A Taylor rule based on a price index that incorporates rents generates more consumption and inflation volatility than one which ignores rents. The welfare-optimal weight on rent inflation is negative under general demand, rental supply, and cost-push shocks: central banks should react to rent increases with accommodative policy.

Working Papers

Intergenerational Welfare Assessments

with Eduardo Dávila and Andreas Schaab (2026), **NBER Working Paper No. 34616**

This paper studies welfare assessments in economies with rich demographics. We introduce the notion of demographically disconnected economies, those with no date at which all individuals are concurrently alive. We identify the unique class of units that always enables meaningful welfare comparisons in such economies:

those based on perpetual consumption, that is, consumption at all dates. Using these units, we uncover a novel possibility: feasible perturbations of Pareto efficient allocations can yield Kaldor–Hicks efficiency gains. We also introduce a decomposition that attributes intertemporal-sharing efficiency gains to financial frictions or demographic differences. These results allow us to derive new insights in three workhorse intergenerational models: (i) Samuelson (1958) two-date-life model, offering a novel rationale for social security; (ii) Diamond (1965) growth model, providing a new theory for capital taxation and capital over-/under-accumulation; and (iii) Samuelson (1958) three-date-life model, decomposing the efficiency gains from intergenerational transfers into frictional and demographic sources.

Optimal Public Debt Adjustment with Heterogeneous Agents: The Role of Aggregate Risk
(2026)

What is the role of aggregate risk in determining how fast a government should repay the excess public debt contracted during a recession? I study optimal fiscal adjustment in a heterogeneous-agent model with capital and aggregate shocks. High public debt crowds out capital and depresses wages, with severe consequences for hand-to-mouth households. It also raises interest rates, creating a trade-off between capital gains and a redistributive motive. Both effects are stronger in recessions, which is where aggregate risk matters. Numerically, the welfare-maximizing path of debt adjustment is consistent with the one observed in the US, and it departs from tax smoothing because of household heterogeneity and uncertainty about the future.

Work in Progress

Ramsey Optimal Policy in Production Networks with Menu Costs
with Mishel Ghassibe, Anton Nakov and Dominik Thaler (2026), draft available upon request

We study optimal monetary policy in a production network subject to large sectoral shocks, such as a sharp increase in energy prices. With menu costs, firms choose when to adjust prices, so large shocks change the sectoral characteristics that guide inflation stabilization in linearized models. We solve the fully nonlinear Ramsey problem to determine which sectors the central bank should stabilize and when accommodating full price adjustment in one sector is preferable to stabilizing an inflation index.

Presentations

2026: Housing Community of Interest seminar at the Bank of England, ECB Early Ideas Seminar, TSE Macro Workshop

2025: Bank of Mexico Seminar, TSE Macro Workshop

2024: Simposio de la Asociación Española de Economía (SAEe) 2024, TSE–Bank of Mauritius Workshop, TSE Macro Workshop

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Toulouse School of Economics

- Macroeconomics (1st year Ph.D.) — Winter 2025
- Macroeconomics (Master) — Fall 2024
- Public Economics (Master) — Winter 2024-2025
- Macroeconomics 2 (Bachelor) — Winter 2023-2024
- Macroeconomics 3 (Bachelor) — Fall 2023

Summer Schools

Princeton Initiative: Macro, Money and Finance — Summer 2023
with Markus Brunnermeier and Yuliy Sannikov — *Princeton*

Heterogeneous-Agent Macro Workshop — Spring 2023
with Adrien Auclert, Bence Bardóczy, Matthew Rognlie and Ludwig Straub — *NBER, Cambridge*

Advanced Numerical Methods in Macroeconomics — Summer 2022
with Jesús Fernández-Villaverde and Galo Nuño — *CEMFI, Madrid*

Awards and Scholarships

Doctoral Fellowship, French Ministry of Higher Education and Research — 2022 – 2026

TSE Scholarship — 2021 – 2022

Other Research Activities

Organizer, TSE Macro Workshop

Collaborator, `DS-weights` repository on GitHub (toolbox to compute welfare assessments), with Eduardo Dávila and Andreas Schaab

Other

Languages: Catalan (native), Spanish (native), English (fluent), French (fluent)

References

Fabrice Collard (Main Advisor) — fabrice.collard@tse-fr.eu
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Anton Nakov — anton.nakov@ecb.europa.eu
Principal Economist, European Central Bank

Personal Information

Citizenship: Spanish

Date of Birth: June 10, 1999

Last updated: November 2026